Class 6 Social Science – Chapter: Introduction: Why Social Science?

Book: Exploring Society: India and Beyond Medium: Simple English Based on: Your uploaded PDF, with all the important topics, textbook questions, and additional exam-oriented questions and answers.

इस PDF के शुरुआती अध्याय "Introduction – Why Social Science?" में Social Science का अर्थ, उसका महत्त्व और पाँच मुख्य Themes दिए गए हैं। ध्यान दें कि इसी PDF के पृष्ठ 7 से अगला अध्याय, "Locating Places on the Earth," शुरू हो जाता है। इसलिए नीचे पहले Introduction के सभी विषयों को शामिल किया गया है और उसके बाद PDF में दिए गए अगले अध्याय के प्रश्नों को भी कवर किया गया है, ताकि आपकी तैयारी अधूरी न रहे।

Part A: Introduction – Why Social Science?

1. Important questions and answers

Q1. What is Social Science?

Answer: Social Science is the study of human society, people's lives, their relationships, their past, their culture, government, and economic activities.

Q2. Why do we study Social Science?

Answer: We study Social Science to understand our world and human society. It helps us solve social problems, live peacefully, and build a better future.

Q3. What are the main challenges facing humanity today?

Answer: The main challenges are wars, armed conflicts, social tensions, environmental problems, and the rapid changes caused by technology.

Q4. How can Social Science help us?

Answer: Social Science helps us understand society, learn from the past, understand the present, and prepare for a better future.

Q5. Is Social Science the same as Physics or Chemistry?

Answer: No. Social Science studies human society. It uses scientific methods wherever possible, but human societies are very diverse and complex.

Q6. Name the main branches of Social Science.

Answer: The main branches are:

- Geography
- History
- Political Science
- Economics
- Sociology
- Anthropology
- Archaeology
- Psychology

Q7. What is the main aim of Social Science?

Answer: Its main aim is to understand human society and help people make informed decisions for a better future.

Q8. Why is it important to ask questions in Social Science?

Answer: Asking questions helps us understand problems and search for the right answers.

Q9. What is multidisciplinarity?

Answer: Multidisciplinarity means bringing ideas and knowledge from different subjects together to understand a topic better.

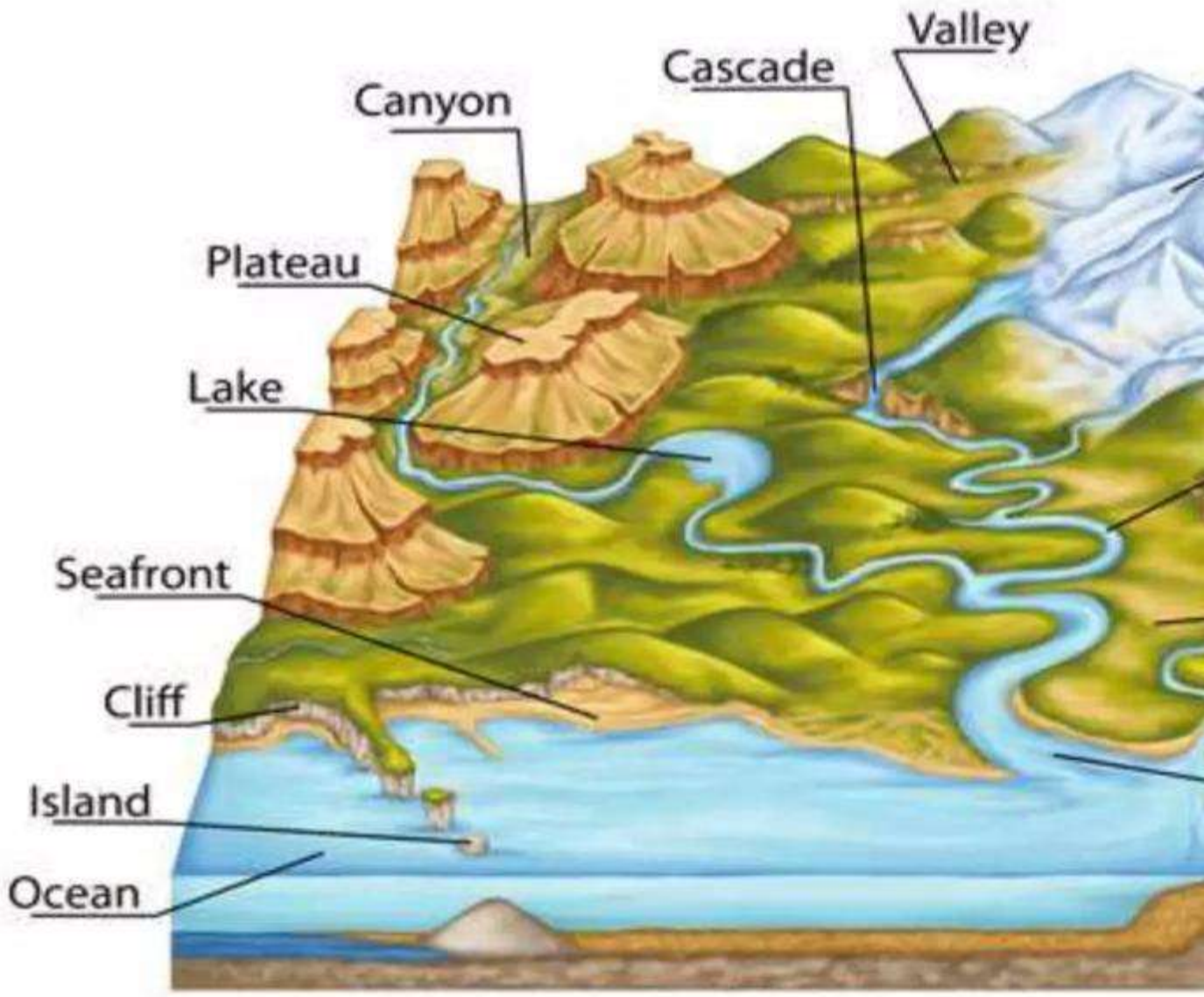
Q10. How does Social Science connect the past, present, and future?

Answer: It helps us learn from the past, understand the present, and make better plans for the future.

2. The five main themes of Social Science

The textbook introduces five broad themes. These are very important for examinations.

Earth Surface Lan



Theme A – India and the World: Land and the People

Q. What do we study in Theme A?

Answer: We study the Earth, maps, oceans, mountains, rivers, and the relationship between geographical features and human civilisation.



Theme B – Tapestry of the Past

Q. Why should we study the past?

Answer: We study the past to understand the present, learn about our identity, and avoid repeating past mistakes.



Theme C – Our Cultural Heritage and Knowledge Traditions

Q. What do we learn in Theme C?

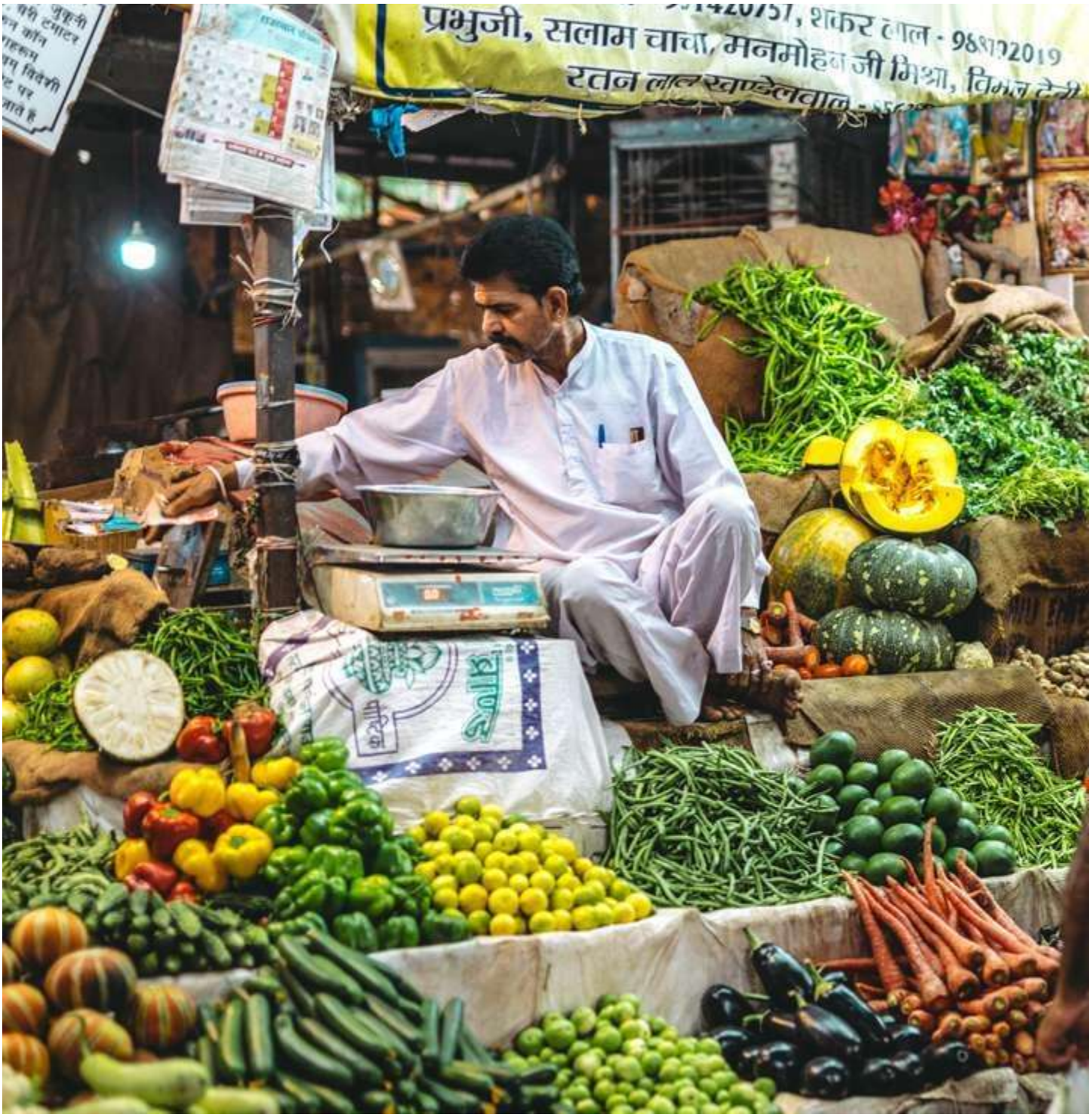
Answer: We learn about India's rich culture, traditions, guiding principles, and knowledge systems.



Theme D – Governance and Democracy

Q. Why should citizens understand government?

Answer: Citizens should understand government to know their rights and duties, participate in decision-making, and become responsible citizens.



Theme E – Economic Life Around Us

Q. What do we study in Theme E?

Answer: We study money, work, livelihoods, economic activities, and the management of natural and human resources.

3. More important questions from each theme

Q11. What is the importance of geography?

Answer: Geography helps us understand the Earth, its natural features, and how people live in different places.

Q12. How does geography influence human civilisation?

Answer: Mountains, rivers, oceans, and other geographical features influence people's lives, occupations, and the growth of civilisations.

Q13. What is history?

Answer: History is the study of the past. It helps us understand how people lived and how societies changed over time.

Q14. How can history help us avoid mistakes?

Answer: History tells us about past mistakes made by people, rulers, and governments. We can learn from these mistakes and avoid repeating them.

Q15. What is cultural heritage?

Answer: Cultural heritage includes the traditions, values, art, knowledge, and practices passed from one generation to another.

Q16. What is democracy?

Answer: Democracy is a system of government in which people have the power to choose their representatives.

Q17. What are the duties of citizens?

Answer: Citizens should obey the law, respect others, protect public property, and perform their responsibilities towards society and the country.

Q18. What is an economy?

Answer: An economy is a system through which people produce, distribute, and use goods and services.

Q19. What are the basic needs of a family?

Answer: The basic needs of a family include food, clothing, shelter, water, livelihood, and education.

Q20. What is the importance of natural and human resources?

Answer: Natural resources provide materials from nature, while human resources include people's knowledge, skills, and abilities. Both are important for development.

Q21. Why does the textbook combine different subjects?

Answer: It combines different subjects because real-life problems often involve many areas of knowledge. This approach is called multidisciplinarity.

4. Textbook activity: Let’s Explore (pages 2–3)

The textbook asks questions about a picture showing a lake, a road, a mountain, trees, and a small house. These are sample answers; the picture does not give all the details.

Q1. Where does the water in the lake come from?

Answer: The water may come from rainfall, streams, rivers, or underground water.

Q2. Who made the road and why?

Answer: The road may have been built by the local government or another authority to connect places and help people travel.

Q3. What activities may people living in the small house do?

Answer: They may farm, keep animals, collect forest products, or do other local work.

Q4. What could be the history and future of the place?

Answer: People may have lived there for many years. In the future, the place may develop better roads, houses, schools, and other facilities.

Q5. How can we find answers to questions about our surroundings?

Answer: We can observe the area, read books and maps, talk to local people, and collect information.

Part B: Chapter 1 – Locating Places on the Earth

The remaining pages of your PDF cover this chapter. Below are the topic-wise questions, definitions, solved textbook questions, and extra exam questions in simple English.

1. Maps and their components

Q1. What is a map?

Answer: A map is a drawing or representation of an area of the Earth as seen from above.

Q2. What is an atlas?

Answer: An atlas is a book or collection of maps.

Q3. Name the three main types of maps.

Answer:

1. Physical maps
2. Political maps
3. Thematic maps

Q4. What is a physical map?

Answer: A physical map shows natural features such as mountains, rivers, and oceans.

Q5. What is a political map?

Answer: A political map shows countries, states, their boundaries, cities, and capitals.

Q6. What is a thematic map?

Answer: A thematic map shows a particular type of information, such as rainfall, population, or crops.

Q7. Name the three main components of a map.

Answer: The three main components are distance, direction, and symbols.

Q8. What is the scale of a map?

Answer: A map scale shows the relationship between a distance on the map and the actual distance on the ground.

Q9. What does the scale 1 cm = 500 m mean?

Answer: It means that 1 centimetre on the map represents 500 metres on the ground.

Q10. Why is a map scale important?

Answer: It helps us calculate the actual distance between two places.

Q11. What are the cardinal directions?

Answer: The four cardinal directions are North, South, East, and West.

Q12. What are the intermediate directions?

Answer: The intermediate directions are Northeast (NE), Southeast (SE), Southwest (SW), and Northwest (NW).

Q13. Why do we use symbols on maps?

Answer: Symbols represent buildings, roads, rivers, railway lines, and other features in a small space.

Q14. Why are colours used on maps?

Answer: Colours help us identify and distinguish different features of a map more easily. Their meanings depend on the map's key or legend.

Q15. What is the Survey of India?

Answer: The Survey of India is a government organisation that prepares maps of India and uses standard map symbols.

Quick revision: Maps

Term	Simple meaning
Map	Drawing of an area as seen from above
Atlas	Collection of maps
Scale	Relationship between map distance and actual distance
Physical map	Shows natural features
Political map	Shows boundaries and settlements
Thematic map	Shows a particular kind of information
Symbols	Signs representing features
Cardinal directions	North, South, East, West

2. The globe and mapping the Earth

Q16. What is a globe?

Answer: A globe is a spherical model of the Earth on which a map is drawn.

Q17. Why is a globe more accurate than a flat world map?

Answer: A globe has a shape similar to the Earth, so it represents the Earth's shape more accurately.

Q18. Why is it difficult to represent the Earth accurately on a flat sheet?

Answer: The Earth is nearly spherical. Its curved surface cannot be flattened completely without distortion.

Q19. Is the Earth a perfect sphere?

Answer: No. The Earth is slightly flattened at the poles.

Q20. What is the difference between a map and a globe?

Answer: A map is a flat representation of an area, while a globe is a spherical model of the Earth.

3. Coordinates and latitudes

Q21. What are coordinates?

Answer: Coordinates are two values used together to identify the exact location of a place.

Q22. What is the Equator?

Answer: The Equator is an imaginary circle around the middle of the Earth. It divides the Earth into the Northern and Southern Hemispheres.

Q23. What is latitude?

Answer: Latitude measures the angular distance of a place north or south of the Equator.

Q24. What are parallels of latitude?

Answer: Parallels of latitude are imaginary circles running east to west, parallel to the Equator.

Q25. What is the latitude of the Equator?

Answer: The latitude of the Equator is 0°.

Q26. What are the latitudes of the North Pole and South Pole?

Answer: The North Pole is at 90°N and the South Pole is at 90°S.

Q27. Do all parallels of latitude have the same length?

Answer: No. The Equator is the longest parallel. The other parallels become smaller towards the poles.

Q28. How is latitude related to climate?

Answer: Areas near the Equator are generally hotter. Areas near the poles are colder.

Q29. Name the three broad climate zones mentioned in the chapter.

Answer:

- Torrid zone: generally hot
- Temperate zone: moderate climate
- Frigid zone: very cold

4. Longitudes and the Prime Meridian

Q30. What is longitude?

Answer: Longitude measures the angular distance of a place east or west of the Prime Meridian.

Q31. What are meridians of longitude?

Answer: They are imaginary half-circles running from the North Pole to the South Pole.

Q32. What is the Prime Meridian?

Answer: The Prime Meridian is the reference line at 0° longitude. It passes through Greenwich in London, England.

Q33. Why is it called the Greenwich Meridian?

Answer: It is called the Greenwich Meridian because it passes through Greenwich, an area of London.

Q34. What are the maximum values of longitude east and west?

Answer: Longitude extends to 180°E and 180°W. These represent the same meridian on opposite sides of the globe.

Q35. How do latitude and longitude help us locate a place?

Answer: Latitude tells us how far north or south a place is, and longitude tells us how far east or west it is. Together, they identify a location.

Q36. What is a grid on a globe?

Answer: A grid is the network formed by the intersecting lines of latitude and longitude.

Q37. What was the ancient Indian Prime Meridian?

Answer: Ancient Indian astronomers used the madhya rekhā, or middle line, passing through Ujjayinī (modern Ujjain).

Q38. Who was Varāhamihira?

Answer: Varāhamihira was a famous Indian astronomer who lived and worked in Ujjayinī about 1,500 years ago.

Q39. What are the Northern, Southern, Eastern, and Western Hemispheres?

Answer: The Equator divides the Earth into the Northern and Southern Hemispheres. The Prime Meridian and the opposite 180° meridian divide it into the Eastern and Western Hemispheres.

5. Local time, standard time, and time zones

Q40. Why does local time differ from place to place?

Answer: The Earth rotates from west to east. Therefore, different places experience sunrise and noon at different times.

Q41. How many degrees does the Earth rotate in one hour?

Answer: The Earth rotates 15° in one hour because it rotates 360° in 24 hours.

Q42. What happens to local time when we move east?

Answer: Local time becomes later as we move east.

Q43. What happens to local time when we move west?

Answer: Local time becomes earlier as we move west.

Q44. What is local time?

Answer: Local time is the time based on the position of the Sun at a particular place.

Q45. What is standard time?

Answer: Standard time is the common time adopted by a country or region, based on a selected reference meridian.

Q46. What is Indian Standard Time (IST)?

Answer: Indian Standard Time is the standard time followed throughout India. It is 5 hours 30 minutes ahead of Greenwich Mean Time (GMT).

Q47. Why does India need one standard time?

Answer: India is a large country. One standard time makes travel, communication, school timings, and official work easier to organise.

Q48. What is a time zone?

Answer: A time zone is a region that follows a common standard time.

Q49. Why do time-zone boundaries not always follow straight meridians?

Answer: They are adjusted to respect the borders of countries and regions.

Q50. Do all countries have only one time zone?

Answer: No. Large countries such as Russia, Canada, and the USA have several time zones.

Q51. What is the International Date Line?

Answer: The International Date Line lies approximately along 180° longitude. Crossing it changes the calendar date by one day.

Q52. What happens when we cross the International Date Line?

Answer: When travelling eastward across it, we subtract one day. When travelling westward, we add one day.

Part C: All textbook questions with answers

These questions are from the “Questions, activities and projects” section on pages 24–25 of your PDF.

Q1. Calculate the real distance from the estuary of the Narmada River to the estuary of the Ganga River.

Given:

- Map scale = 2.5 cm = 500 km
- Therefore, 1 cm = 200 km

Formula:

Actual distance = Map distance × Scale value per centimetre

Answer: If the measured distance on the map is d cm, the actual distance is $d \times 200$ km.

The map of Chapter 5, Figure 5.2, is not included in this PDF, so the exact measured distance cannot be confirmed from the uploaded file alone.

Q2. Why is it 5:30 pm in India when it is 12 noon in London?

Answer: India is east of Greenwich. Local time becomes later towards the east. Indian Standard Time is 5 hours and 30 minutes ahead of Greenwich Mean Time.

Therefore,

12:00 noon + 5 hours 30 minutes = 5:30 pm in India.

Q3. Why do we need symbols and colours on maps?

Answer: Symbols and colours help us show different features clearly in a small space. They make maps easy to read and understand. Symbols can represent roads, railway stations, rivers, schools, and other features.

Q4. Find what you have in the eight directions from your home or school.

Answer: This is a local activity. Students should identify the places around their own home or school.

The eight directions are:

1. North
2. Northeast
3. East
4. Southeast
5. South
6. Southwest
7. West
8. Northwest

For example, a student may find a school to the north, a market to the east, and a pond to the west. These are only examples; use the actual surroundings.

Q5. What is the difference between local time and standard time?

Answer:

Local time is the time based on the position of the Sun at a particular place. It can differ from one place to another because the Earth rotates from west to east.

Standard time is the common time followed by a country or region. It is based on a selected reference meridian. India follows Indian Standard Time (IST), which is 5 hours 30 minutes ahead of GMT.

Standard time helps people coordinate their daily activities, travel, communication, and official work.

Q6. Delhi and Bengaluru have latitudes of 29°N and 13°N. Their longitudes are almost the same, 77°E. What is the difference in their local time?

Answer:

- Delhi's longitude = 77°E
- Bengaluru's longitude = 77°E

Local time depends on longitude, not latitude.

Since both cities have almost the same longitude, their local times are almost the same.

Difference in local time = approximately 0 minutes.

Q7. State whether the following statements are True or False. Explain your answers.

Statement	Answer	Reason
1. All parallels of latitude have the same length.	False	The Equator is the longest; other parallels become smaller towards the poles.
2. The length of a meridian of longitude is half that of the Equator.	True	A meridian is a half-circle, while the Equator is a full circle.
3. The South Pole has a latitude of 90°S.	True	The South Pole is at 90 degrees south

		latitude.
4. In Assam, local time and IST are identical.	False	Local time in Assam is ahead of IST because Assam lies farther east.
5. Lines separating time zones are identical to meridians of longitude.	False	Time-zone boundaries often bend to follow country borders.
6. The Equator is also a parallel of latitude.	True	It is the parallel at 0° latitude.

Q8. Solve the crossword: Locating Places on Earth

The following are the answers to the clues on page 25.

Direction	No.	Clue	Answer
Across	1	Lets you squeeze a huge area into your map	Scale
Across	4	A convenient sphere	Globe
Across	5	The longest parallel of latitude	Equator
Across	6	The place the Prime Meridian is attached to	Greenwich
Across	8	So convenient to find your way	Map
Across	10	A measure of the distance from the Equator	Latitude
Down	2	A measure of the distance from the Prime Meridian	Longitude
Down	3	These two together allow us to locate a place	Coordinates
Down	6	What latitudes and longitudes together create	Grid
Down	7	The time we all follow in India	IST
Down	9	On top of the world	North Pole
Down	11	An abbreviation for a line across which the day and date change	IDL

Part D: Additional important exam questions

These questions cover the key concepts that students may be asked in short-answer or long-answer examinations.

Very short-answer questions

Q1. What is the latitude of the Equator?

Answer: 0° latitude.

Q2. What is the longitude of the Prime Meridian?

Answer: 0° longitude.

Q3. In which direction does the Earth rotate?

Answer: From west to east.

Q4. How many hours does the Earth take to complete one rotation?

Answer: 24 hours.

Q5. How many degrees does the Earth rotate in 24 hours?

Answer: 360°.

Q6. How many degrees of longitude correspond to one hour?

Answer: 15°.

Q7. What is the standard time of India called?

Answer: Indian Standard Time (IST).

Q8. Through which city does the Prime Meridian pass?

Answer: Greenwich in London, England.

Q9. Which imaginary line divides the Earth into the Northern and Southern Hemispheres?

Answer: The Equator.

Q10. What is the approximate longitude of the International Date Line?

Answer: 180° longitude.

Short-answer questions

Q11. Why is the Equator the longest parallel of latitude?

Answer: The Equator passes around the widest part of the Earth. The circles of latitude become smaller towards the poles.

Q12. Why are latitudes and longitudes called imaginary lines?

Answer: They are drawn on maps and globes to locate places. They are not actual lines on the Earth's surface.

Q13. Why is longitude useful for calculating time?

Answer: The Earth rotates 15° in one hour. Therefore, the difference in longitude helps us calculate the difference in local time.

Q14. What is the relationship between the Prime Meridian and the International Date Line?

Answer: The Prime Meridian is at 0° longitude, while the International Date Line lies approximately at 180° longitude, on the opposite side of the Earth.

Q15. Why do places in eastern India experience sunrise earlier than places in western India?

Answer: The Earth rotates from west to east. Therefore, eastern places face the Sun earlier than western places.

Numerical questions

Q16. If it is 12 noon at Greenwich, what is the local time at 30°E?

Answer:

- 15° longitude = 1 hour
- 30° longitude = 2 hours

Since the place is east of Greenwich, add 2 hours.

Local time = 2:00 pm.

Q17. If it is 12 noon at Greenwich, what is the local time at 45°W?

Answer:

- 15° longitude = 1 hour
- 45° longitude = 3 hours

Since the place is west of Greenwich, subtract 3 hours.

Local time = 9:00 am.

Q18. What is the time difference between two places separated by 60° longitude?

Answer:

\[\text{Time difference}=\frac{60^\circ}{15^\circ} =4\text{ hours} \]

The eastern place has a local time four hours ahead of the western place.

Q19. If it is 10:00 am at 30°E, what is the local time at 15°E?

Answer: The difference in longitude is 15°, which equals one hour. The place at 15°E is farther west, so its local time is one hour earlier.

Local time = 9:00 am.

Q20. If it is 8:00 am at 15°W, what is the local time at 15°E?

Answer: The difference in longitude is 30°.

\[30^\circ \div 15^\circ=2\text{ hours} \]

The eastern place is two hours ahead.

Local time = 10:00 am.

Final revision: Important definitions to learn

Term	Definition in simple English
Social Science	The study of human society and people's lives
Map	A representation of an area of the Earth
Atlas	A collection of maps
Globe	A spherical model of the Earth
Scale	The relationship between map distance and actual distance
Latitude	Angular distance north or south of the Equator
Longitude	Angular distance east or west of the Prime Meridian
Coordinates	Values used together to identify a location
Equator	The imaginary line at 0° latitude
Prime Meridian	The reference line at 0° longitude
Local time	Time based on the Sun's position at a place
Standard time	The common time adopted by a country or region
Time zone	A region that follows a common standard time
International Date Line	An approximate line near 180° longitude where crossing changes the date

Exam preparation tip: First learn the definitions, the five themes of Social Science, the difference between latitude and longitude, and the calculations involving time. Then practise the textbook True/False questions and crossword. These cover the central concepts presented in your PDF.